previously. As discussed in Chapter 3, China's challenge to the system comes both by reforming from within the existing governance institutions largely built by the West and selectively creating new parallel institutions outside of that architecture. Why has China preferred employing the BRICS and collaborating within it as a way to pursue its financial statecraft strategy for the last several years in the face of its impressive rise? Will China pursue a path of revisionism in the face of a worrying economic slowdown and what would that path mean to the BRICS cooperation?

Changes and Continuities in China's Stance Toward Global Governance

China under the Chinese Communist Party (CCP) has a history of protecting its economic and monetary autonomy, including by defensive financial statecraft, to sustain its economic growth model through self-reliance. Less recognized is the history of China's commitment to multilateralism and its self-image as an important member of the international financial community. The history of the Bretton Woods institutions is illustrative. For the Bretton Woods Conference in June 1944, the Chinese government (under the Kuomintang) sent a thirty-two-member delegation, the second-largest behind the United States, and its chief delegate was Kong Xiangxi, the finance minister and governor of the Central Bank.[11] Throughout the discussion on global financial governance after World War II, as a founding member of these institutions, advocated equal treatment of all nations. Chinese officials were also very pleased that China had a large enough quota to symbolize its commitment and presence in international monetary affairs.[12]

Due to the communist triumph in the country's civil war in 1949, and the subsequent conflict over China's international representation throughout the 1950s into the 1970s, communist China was absent from these institutions for decades. After the evolution of both the Bretton Woods institutions and the CCP policies in the late 1970s, and in response to fierce efforts on the part of both the Bretton Woods institutions and CCP leadership, the People's Republic of China (PRC) finally rejoined the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the World Bank in 1980. At this point, China was given the ninth-largest quota and its own executive director (ED) seat. The CCP government immediately began to request an increased quota and representation via a single-country ED seat.[13]